

Delaware County Council Meeting September 26th 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gWQwpPRI8FQ
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: September 26, 2023

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Piper called the regular County Council meeting to order at **00:06:05** on Tuesday, September 26, 2023. The agenda was confirmed as posted, with the addition of a budget-related resolution.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Councilman Hughes, Councilman Mobile, Councilman Webb, Councilman Whitehead, Councilman Piper (President), and council members Ryan and Eugene.
 - **Absent:** Councilman Flanagan.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Rhiannon 00:06:09.
 - **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was amended to add Resolution 2023-019 (required prior to budget adoption on Friday). Approved by roll call vote.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the August 22nd council meeting were approved.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:08:34 County General & Departmental Fund Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various department heads / Finance Committee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed multiple fund transfers across county departments. All transfers carried favorable recommendations from the finance committee. Notable items included:
 - *Circuit Court:* Transfers totaling \$0 (adjusting lines for assistant court reporters, office supplies, installing signs, and office equipment including a new chair for Judge May War and a jury trial podium).
 - *EMS:* Transfers totaling \$0 (pulling from unfilled medic spots to cover end-of-year overtime).
 - *Family Support Division, Prosecutor, Auditor, Ball Brothers High-Tech Crime Unit, Communications, Coroner, Election, Jail, Public Defender, and Sheriff:* Routine year-end balancing transfers to cover software, equipment, personnel costs, and statutory obligations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous voice/roll call across respective votes.
- **00:31:35 Jail Fund Transfer (Inmate Meals)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$136,000 into inmate meals (224 inmate meals). The Sheriff noted that meal costs have increased significantly since taking office (rising from \$1.42 per meal to \$1.89 per meal in the first half of the year), serving over 300,000 meals annually.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:33:31 Outside County General Transfers (EMS, Fairgrounds, High-Tech Crime, Medical Inmate Care, Ineligible Homestead)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various departments.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Approval of capital improvements (ambulance free chassis for EMS, fairgrounds utilities/water, high-tech crime unit renovations funded via IPAC grant, medical inmate care, and ineligible homestead correction funds).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.

- **00:44:20 Ordinance 2023-18: Sheriff Commissary Fund (Second Reading)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading of the ordinance establishing formal guidelines for the Sheriff's Commissary Fund in alignment with state statute. Discussion centered around the catch-all statutory language regarding authorized expenditures mutually agreed upon by the Council and Sheriff.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved on second reading by roll call vote.
 - **00:48:22 Resolution 2023-019: Reduction of Funds**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution covering department budget "give-backs" from the 2023 budget to assist with 2024 budget reductions, required prior to Friday's budget adoption.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:49:47 Council Rules Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilman Eugene / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Revision of council rules regarding the timing of agenda materials delivery to members. To avoid requiring staff to work over weekends, deadlines were adjusted to the Friday prior to regularly scheduled meetings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:51:31 [John Longnaker - Guardian Advocates Inc.]**
 - Provided an annual update on Guardian Advocates (a 501c3 providing adult guardianship/VASIA programs similar to CASA for adults). Highlighted expansion into Delaware County, growth to 16 active clients, and requested ongoing county consideration for 2024 matching support.
 - **00:06:14 (Note: Agenda Item / Presentation) / 01:03:15 [Katie Wolfe - Muncie Animal Care and Services (MAX)]**
 - Spoke during public comment to outline shelter operations, data from August (244 animals taken in, 98.52% live release rate), overcrowding challenges, a recent hoarding case involving 18 cats, and surging food and medical costs. Invited council members to tour the facility.
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Budget adoption meeting scheduled for **Friday, September 29, 2023, at 3:00 PM** in the Council room.

- Next regular council meeting scheduled for **Tuesday, October 24, 2023, at 9:00 AM.**
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Eugene and a second by Matt, confirmed by roll call vote at [01:19:17](#).

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